

Charles Harless

Senior Software Engineering Manager

charles@harless.net | 818-288-5313 | Los Angeles, CA
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/charless> | <https://ceharless.github.io/>

Engineering Leadership | Web & Mobile Applications | Cloud & Media Platforms

Summary

Senior Software Engineering Manager with experience managing and scaling engineering teams in large and complex organizations. Coordinated engineering teams of up to 15 engineers across web and mobile platforms delivering reliable and scalable systems.

- **Scaled Impact:** Successfully launched Disney Movies Anywhere with over 20M+ users
- **Delivery Excellence:** Reduced engineering backlog by up to 75%
- **Operational Efficiency:** Achieved 15% cost reduction in infrastructure through automation
- **Workplace Culture:** Increased team morale by 40-50%
- **Reliability at Scale:** Maintained 99.9% uptime for distributed backend services

Core Competencies

- **Leadership:** Team Building, Coaching & Mentorship, Career Development, Roadmap Planning, Agile Development, Stakeholder Management, Resource Planning
- **Architecture:** AWS, Distributed Systems, System Design, Scalability & Performance, Microservices, Web Services, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Technology:** Java, Spring, Node.js, JavaScript/TypeScript, MongoDB, MySQL, GitHub, REST

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineering Manager
Thinking Bear Consulting, Los Angeles, CA
July 2023 - Present

- Drove technical direction for client's high-traffic AWS-hosted web applications
- Client list includes Disney, UCLA, Luna Juice Bar, and various confidential clients

Computer Science Instructor
UCLA Extension, Los Angeles, CA
August 2015 - Present

- Instructed Java, Web Applications, and Data Structures courses
- Received 4.7/5.0 instructor rating from students based on teaching real-world examples

Software Engineering Manager
Brightcove, Boston, MA
January 2023 - June 2023

- Directed 14 engineers across 2 teams to develop AWS-based media and web applications
- Improved release frequency by 20% via process enhancements and automation
- Eliminated 75% of engineering backlog via capacity planning and prioritization
- Enhanced developer engagement by 40% via individualized growth plans and mentoring

Software Development Manager
Amazon Prime Video, Culver City, CA
January 2021 - June 2022

- Supervised 7 engineers to develop media applications with 25+ backend services
- Decreased time-to-market by 15% via iterative delivery, delegation, and accountability
- Coordinated security updates of 2,000+ applications to attain 100% compliance in 1 week
- Established development programs to increase team morale and engagement by 50%

Technical Lead

NBCUniversal, Universal City, CA

April 2016 - December 2020

- Modernized architectural vision for enterprise platforms serving 23,000+ internal users
- Advised engineering team on modernization of portals to increase workforce productivity by 10%
- Authored coding standards to increase quality and reliability of software releases by 15%

Principal Software Engineer

Sage Software, Irvine, CA

May 2015 - March 2016

- Created a cross-platform mobile framework that reduced time-to-market by 20%
- Evaluated cutting-edge technologies like blockchain and facial recognition for use in products

Technical Lead

Walt Disney Studios, Burbank, CA

November 2011 - April 2015

- Launched Disney Movies Anywhere platform serving 20M+ users with 99.9% uptime
- Guided team of 15 developers to design multi-platform streaming applications with Java
- Developed high availability REST API services to support millions of daily transactions
- Collaborated with product and operations teams to improve reliability and performance

Senior Software Engineer

Walt Disney Parks & Resorts, Glendale, CA

December 2005 - October 2011

- Defined application architecture to increase platform scalability by 20%
- Designed semantic data models to improve reuse and system integration

Education

- Master of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of California Los Angeles
- Bachelor of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of Alabama

Certifications

- Certified ScrumMaster, Scrum Alliance
- Certified Scrum Product Owner, Scrum Alliance
- Generative AI Fundamentals Certificate, Databricks